

Curriculum Vitae



CLIFF SAMUEL

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Career Summary

I am a versatile communication professional with more than 30 years of vast and varied experience in fields as diverse as journalism, advertising, public relations, brand promotion, market research, corporate communication, content management, etc.

Experience Details

- At present, I am an independent **Communications Specialist** and work from home on a variety of projects for a variety of clients, cutting across sectors, as a freelancer.
- For a short while, I was the **Creative Director** at Velocita Brand Consultants Private Limited. My role included, but was not restricted to, leading and directing the team of copywriters, recruiting new talent, overseeing copy that ultimately figured in the creative output of the agency, working with the head of the Client-engagement Team to deliver what clients expected, helping with new client pitches, etc. (February to May 2019)
- I was attached to Dilip Oak's Academy as a full-time **Consultant**. Dilip Oak's Academy is Pune's pioneering private academy, which prepares mainly engineering graduates for admission to US, Canadian and German universities, by training them for qualifying exams such as GRE, GMAT, TOEFL and IELTS. Other than helping students draft their statements of purpose and letters of recommendation, I also helped them build their resume. Further, I oversaw the website content of the Academy and produced all the content that went into our marketing collateral from time to time. I played an active role in brand promotion and public relations as well. (2016 to 2019)
- I was on a semi-sabbatical for a while, when I was associated with 'Intellectual Post', a **Consulting Editor**. The 'Intellectual Post' describes itself as "the world's first professional 'views-paper' committed to preserving, protecting, promoting and publishing fiercely independent and thought-provoking content." Besides, I **freelanced** for Orbis

Research, which makes available research material related to the latest market-related news, trends and forecasts, for academicians and business leaders; and also for an IT company for a while, known as Integrative Systems. This is an American MNC. (2015-16)

- I worked briefly for Symbiosis Centre for Distance Learning as the **Head — Corporate Communications, Media and Editorial**. I assisted with the building of their PR strategies, helped formulate internal communication plans, supported the brand promotion team with event planning and execution, assisted in putting together a media-relations strategy, managed media inquiries and interview requests, created content for marketing collaterals, monitored social media for adverse publicity, analysed the effectiveness of our PR results, etc. (2014-15)
- I was attached to one of the leading advertising agencies in Pune, Setu Advertising, as a **Consultant Creative Director – Copy**. I headed their team of copywriters and played the role of facilitating and overseeing their work, other than being a vital, quality-control checkpoint. I also coached and mentored the team of copywriters. (2014)
- I worked for Nalco Water India Limited, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the US-based MNC, Ecolab, which had over 40,000 people around the world at that time. I worked for the Company in the capacity of a **Senior Communications Specialist**. My job involved a combination of "corp com" and "Marcom" related work, which included but was not restricted to vetting white papers, case studies, internal memos; assisting the Managing Director (India) with his speeches and presentations; editing our monthly newsletter for private circulation in India; liaising with external service providers and stakeholders whose expertise we sought such as a PR and advertising agencies, etc. (2011-13).
- I have been attached to St. Mira's College as a **Guest Lecturer** in the past and have held lectures on **Advertising** for final year students of BBA in the past.
- I worked for Pratisaad Communications, a leading advertising agency in Pune, as a **Senior Copywriter**. I worked on several brands representing diverse sectors, from FMCGs to educational institutions, real estate to healthcare, to name a few. (2010-11)
- I was a part of Seagull Advertising in the capacity of a **Senior Copy Writer**. I was responsible for writing content for brochures, leaflets, newsletters, press releases, e-mailers, corporate websites and AV scripts for corporate films. I also worked on print ad campaigns off and on. A couple of my ads were even put up on www.afaqs.com at that time. (2008–10)
- I served a multinational e-learning company, Aptara, as a **Language QA Expert**. My job included scrutinising content (for language errors and inconsistencies) of e-learning courseware. We produced this courseware for corporate clients in the US and UK. (2008)
- I worked for Sakal Media Group (known as the Sakaal Group of Publications at that time) as an **Assistant Manager (Brand Promotion)** for almost two years. I was responsible for all outgoing communication in English, such as in-house advertisements, e-mailers, flyers, danglers, brochures, hoardings, PR and promotional material, etc. (2006–08)
- I was a crucial part of the core team of a startup software company, Shrikant S.S. & Company, for almost three years, as a **Research Writer**. I undertook extensive Internet-based research related to 'fintech' and was involved in content development. We worked on Web-based projects offering business solutions to our clients in the US. (2003–06)
- I worked as a **Copywriter** for an advertising agency, Hitendra Advertising and Marketing Pvt. Ltd., for one year. I also doubled up as the **Assistant Editor** for a bilingual youth magazine, *Yuvahit*, published by the Managing Director. Other than the editorial, which was written by me, some of my articles were also published in the magazine. (2002–03)
- I was a part of a health portal, *aarogya.com*, hosted by T-Edge Solutions Pvt. Ltd., as a **Content Writer/Research Analyst** for a period of two years. I edited the English content that was uploaded on our website. I also undertook extensive research and even contributed my original articles, which were uploaded on our website. (1999–2001)
- I served as a **Sub-editor** at *Maharashtra Herald*, Pune's pioneering English daily, for a period of three years. My job included selecting news, editing it, giving edited news stories suitable headlines, laying out pages, and checking laid-out pages, before they went to the press for printing. I wrote extensively for my newspaper on a variety of topics, and also freelanced for the Pune edition of *The Indian Express*. (1996-99)

- I worked for one academic year as a **Teacher/Counselor** at an international school in Panchgani, New Era School. I taught English to students from overseas, particularly the United Kingdom, and prepared them for the 'O' Levels examinations of the GCSE, England. Further, I also taught History to 10th graders belonging to the CBSE system. (1995–96)

Academic Credentials

- **SSC** through St. Vincent's High School, Pune, with a **first class**.
- **HSC** in Arts through Fergusson College, Pune, with a **first class**.
- **BA** with **English Literature** as my major subject, and **Psychology** and **Sociology** as subsidiary subjects, through the same college, which is affiliated to the University of Pune (since renamed as Savitribai Phule Pune University), with a **first class**.
- **MA** in **History** through the University of Pune, with a **first class**.
- Passed the **IELTS** exam with an overall band score of **7.5 out of 9**.
- I picked up the basics of **IT** at Aptech. My course curriculum included computer fundamentals, Internet usage and MS-Office.
- I read for an **MA** in **Mass Communications and Journalism**, offered by Alagappa University in Tamil Nadu, through distance education, took seven out of the 10 papers, which constitute the curriculum, and cleared all of them.
- I have completed **short-term online training offered through Udemy** and have certificates to show for it in the following: '**30 Quick Marketing Strategies**', '**Content Ideation and Marketing Funnels**', '**Content Marketing and Influence Building**', '**Copy Writing that Sells**', '**Creating a Complete Marketing Campaign in 1 Hour**', '**Create an Inspired Marketing Plan**', and '**Digital Marketing Basics**'.

Additional Training

- Attended a workshop on the **Principles of Six Sigma** and how they could be used to progressively evaluate and improve work performance. This workshop was organised by the Sakaal Group of Publications (now known as Sakal Media Group). It was conducted by a "black belt" in Six Sigma.
- Participated in a workshop on '**Advertising System**' conducted by Vinita Dang Mohoni who is Seagull's Strategy Consultant. Vinita has worked for national and multinational companies like Kimberly Clark Lever, Procter & Gamble and Beechams. This alumnus of IIM-Ahmedabad has directed many teams responsible for several successful national brand launches in India like Whisper, Huggies and Mediker, to name just a few.
- Took part in a workshop on '**3-D Advertising**' conducted by Puneet Bhatnagar. 3-D represented dreams, design and delivery. Puneet has years of experience in advertising, marketing and PR. A BE (Mech) and an MBA, he was the Creative Head at Star News.
- Also attended workshops conducted by Sumit Roy in '**Self-financing Promotions**', '**Relationship Marketing**', '**Branding Ideas to Flight Maps**' and '**21st Century Campaign**'. The founder-director of Univbrands, Roy was the Learn-by-Discovery Coach at Northpoint Centre of Learning, the Resource Planning Manager at Lintas India, and the Client Services Manager at Ogilvy & Mather. He specialises in word-of-mouth marketing, self-financing promotions, 21st-century brand building, relationship marketing, idea management, and communication skills.

Personal Particulars

Date of birth: 9th August 1967

Gender and marital status: Male and married

Nationality: Indian

Languages known: English, Hindi, Marathi, Urdu and Tamil

Passport: Valid till 15th March 2021

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